TALENT ACQUISITION IN THE DIGITAL ERA: PRACTICAL INTERNSHIP-BASED PERSPECTIVE

Internship Report submitted to:

MANIPAL ACADEMY OF HIGHER EDUCATION

FOR THE PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR THE AWARD OF THE DEGREE OF

BACHELOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

BY

SATHYA PRASAD N SHETTY
232621032

Under the guidance of

DR. SUHAN MENDON

Additional Professor,

Manipal School of Commerce and Economics, MAHE

SUBMITTED ON:

2nd May 2025

DECLARATION

I, Sathya Prasad N Shetty (232621032), studying Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) at the Manipal School of Commerce and Economics, MAHE, hereby declare that the Internship Report titled**: "Talent Acquisition In The Digital Era: Practical Internship-Based Perspective",** submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Business Administration, is a bona fide record of the project work carried out by me during the internship at Institute of Product Leadership.

This report is the result of my original work and has not been submitted to any other university or institution for the award of any degree, diploma, or certificate. Any information used from external sources has been duly acknowledged and referenced.

I further declare that this report has been prepared under the guidance of Dr. Suhan Mendon, Additional Professor, Manipal School of Commerce and Economics, MAHE

Date: 2nd May 2025

Sathya Prasad N Shetty
232621032

MANIPAL
ACADEMY of HIGHER EDUCATION
(Institution of Eminence Deemed to be University)

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that project report titled **"Talent Acquisition In The Digital Era: Practical Internship-Based Perspective"** is submitted to Manipal School of Commerce and Economics, Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), towards partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of B. Com/BBA degree. **Mr. Sathya Prasad N Shetty, Reg. No. 232621032** has worked under my supervision and guidance. No part of this report has been earlier submitted for the award of any Degree, Diploma, Fellowship or any other similar title or prizes. The work has not been published in any journal or magazine.

Signature of Faculty Guide & Name

Date : 2nd May 2025
Place : Manipal

New Management Block, Near 9th Block, MIT Campus, Manipal 576 104, Karnataka, India• Ph: 91820 2925342
• Fax: 91 820 2925341 • e-mail: doc.office@manipal.edu

CERTIFICATE FROM THE COMPANY

I have not received my certification letter as my internship period was extended till 4th June 2025. As a proof for my internship extension I will be attaching the screenshot of the mail sent by the HR and will submit the experience letter once received.

3 of 1,711

Internship Extension Confirmation Inbox ×

Geetanjali Deshmukh 6:10 PM (2 hours ago)
to me, Nabeel

Hi Sathya,

I hope you are doing well.

I am writing to formally inform you about the extension of your internship. Initially, your internship was scheduled for 3 months. However, based on your strong performance and mutual agreement, we are pleased to extend your internship until 4th June 2025.

We look forward to your continued learning and valuable contributions towards our mission of creating 10,000 product leaders in India.

Cheers,
Geetanjali Deshmukh
Assistant Manager - HR
+91 7566822536 | productleadership.com
Institute of PRODUCT LEADERSHIP

My internship started on 4th December 2025 and will go up to 4th June 2025. Kindly find the attached offer letter below.

Scanned copy of the internship offer letter:

adaptive MARKETING

TRAINING • CONSULTING • EXECUTION

Date: 22nd November 2024

Dear Sathya Prasad N Shetty,

With reference to your recent interview, we are pleased to offer you an internship at **Adaptive Marketing Solutions Pvt Ltd, No.1, KDP Building, 3rd Floor, Kira Layout, Dharmaram College Post, Opposite Forum Mall, Hosur Main Road, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560029.**

Please see the specifics regarding your internship below.

Internship Title: Talent Acquisition Intern

Start Date: 4th December 2024

Internship Stipend: INR 15,000/month (Fifteen Thousand only)

Duration: Minimum 3 months

You will be required to submit the following documents on the date of joining. Kindly bring your original certificates for reference.

1) Proof of Date of Birth - Birth Certificate/ Class X Certificate (copy);
2) All Educational Certificates;
3) PAN card - (Copy);
4) Latest passport size photograph (2 Nos);
5) Residence proof - DL/ Passport/ Voter Id (copy);

Congratulations on your Internship!

Yours Sincerely,

For Adaptive Marketing Solutions Pvt Ltd

CONFIDENTIAL

Sai Satish Vedam

Chief Product Officer

(Electronically Signed)

CONFIDENTIAL

SATHYA PRASAD N SHETTY

No.1, KSDP Building, 3rd Floor, Kira Layout,
Hosur Main Road,Bangalore - 560029, Karnataka,India
+91 - 88 - 807 605 55

10181 bilich pl Cupertino,
CA 95014 US
+1 - 713 - 568 - 8154

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I am filled with immense gratitude for providing me with the opportunity to work as a Talent Acquisition intern at The Institute of Product Leadership that allowed me to grow significantly both personally and professionally.

My heartfelt appreciation goes to Ms. Geetanjali Deshmukh, Assistant Manager at The Institute of Product Leadership, whose steady guidance and mentorship during every stage of my internship were crucial for my increased performance and timely completion of my fortnightly report. Additionally, I would like to thank Mr. Nabeel Khan, Director of Sales, for being the guiding light throughout my internship journey.

I sincerely thank Dr. Suhan Mendon for his invaluable guidance and support throughout the completion of this report. I, also express my gratitude to Manipal School of Commerce and Economics, Manipal Academy of Higher Education for providing the opportunity to explore the professional working environment.

Lastly, I would like to extend my gratitude to my family and peers for their support in carrying out my internship successfully.

Regards,
Sathya Prasad N Shetty

232621032

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Chapter 1 – Industry Analysis **10**

1.1 Introduction 10
1.2 Porter's Five Forces Analysis 11
1.3 Porter's Five Forces Analysis for Ed-Tech industry in India 12
1.4 Recent Trends in the Industry 14
1.5 Future Trends and Potential 14

Chapter 2 – Company Analysis **15**

2.1 Introduction 15
2.2 Financial Analysis 15
2.3 Market Analysis 17
2.4 Marketing analysis 17
2.5 SWOC Analysis 19
2.6 Ongoing trends in the company 21
2.7 Company Forecasts 21

Chapter 3 – Discussion on conceptual knowledge applied during internship **22**

3.1 Introduction 22
3.2 Implementation of HRM concepts 22
3.3 Conclusion 28

Chapter 4 – Best Practices and experiential learning **29**

4.1 Introduction 29
4.2 Organizational Behaviour and communication 29
4.3 Structured processes and database management 29
4.4 Analytical skills 30
4.5 Management Skills 31
4.6 Personalization in passive candidate engagement 31
4.7 Conclusion 32

Chapter 5 – Summary of Fortnightly progress **33**

Reference **34**

LIST OF TABLES

Table 1	List of Ed-Tech companies and their focus areas.
Table 2	Annual revenue growth (FY 18-23)
Table 3	Calculation of Avg. Growth percentage of the companies
Table 4	Traffic count change due to SEO technique

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Ed-Tech	: Educational Technology
FY	: Financial Year
HRM	: Human Resource Management
HR	: Human Resource
IPL	: Institute of Product Leadership
OB	: Organizational Behaviour
E-MBA	: Executive Master of Business Administration
CAGR	: Compound Annual Growth Rate
SEO	: Search Engine Optimization
CTC	: Cost to Company
DOJ	: Date of Joining
ATS	: Applicant Tracking System
GTM	: Go-To-Market
TQM	: Total Quality Management
GenAI	: Generative Artificial Intelligence
B2B	: Business to Business
LMS	: Learning Management System
MNC	: Multinational Company

Chapter 1 – Industry Analysis

3.2 Introduction:

The education sector, in recent times have seen major changes, especially in areas of executive education and online certifications. By integrating technology in education, it has led to new branch in education sector known as Ed-Tech.

The Education Technology also known as Ed-Tech, speaks about the shift in the way of learning from traditional methods to modern technology driven approach to education making it more accessible and personalized for the learners. This enhancement in the fields of learning has given rise to the use of different technologies like, online learning platforms, recorded classes, personalized self-paced learning plans and most importantly integration of AI for easy conceptual understanding.

All these transitions greatly came into picture post pandemic as lockdown period led to the digitalization of education by forcing schools and colleges to opt for online mode of education. Even after the pandemic came to an end, Ed-Tech vertical of education industry continued to see the growth. Another main factor that influenced this was the growing demand for flexible learning. With students, it also attracted working professionals who were looking for a career transition as they could up skill themselves through various online courses and trainings offered.

Additionally, several other factors contributed to the growing demand of Ed-Tech vertical, that being;

- Universities implementing hybrid learning models such as pdf based notes for the offline lectures conducted, encouraging to upskill through online course, provision of recorded classes and conducting interactive assignments like quizzes.
- Coaching institutes finding online learning a cost-effective alternative as they can save up in expenses of renting a building, electricity, etc.
- Partnership between Ed-Tech firms with universities to provide industry-relevant certificates to bridge the gap between academic learning and industry demands.

With all the benefits, there are several drawbacks such as security concerns and lack of student engagement in these virtual environment. Since these online platforms possess large amount of data of students as well as learning materials, it becomes vulnerable to various cyber threats and data breach. Having a secure database plays a crucial role in such industries.

As education industry steps into the era of digitalization, opening doors for AI and Technology driven learning, companies still have to overcome challenges of quality of education, data security and develop ways to boost interpersonal student engagement to sustain and prove effectiveness of evolution.

Examples for Ed-Tech Companies:

COMPANIES	HIGHLIGHTS
1. Unacademy	Competitive exam preparation
2. Simplilearn	Industry-based courses and hands on learning.
3. Vedantu	K-12 Education and Competitive exam preparation
4. BYJU's	K-12 video based education and up skilling courses

Table 1: List of Ed-Tech companies and their focus areas.

Growth Analysis

To understand the growth in Ed-Tech companies, we will be considering the annual revenue of the company for different financial years and analyse the surge in numbers post pandemic. This numeric data will help us visualize the growth in Ed-tech industries proving the digitalization era of learning.

COMPANY	FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23
Vedantu	5.3	10.45	24.63	93.6	165.8	120.6
BYJUs	490	1376	2381	2280	5298	6245
Unacademy	5.22	21.89	60	337	719	1044
Simplilearn	150	127	253	341	465	683.9

Table 2: Annual revenue growth (FY 18-23)

Using this data, which contains the annual revenue of selected Ed-tech companies from FY 18-23, we can calculate the yearly growth increase/decrease percentage and then find out the average growth percentage to show the growing demand of this industry.

To determine the percentage change, we use:

Growth % = {(New revenue – Old revenue)/Old revenue} × 100

Company	FY18-19 (%)	FY19-20 (%)	FY20-21 (%)	FY21-22 (%)	FY22-23 (%)	Avg Growth (%)
Vedantu	97.17	135.69	280.02	77.14	-27.26	**112.55**
BYJUs	180.82	73.04	-4.24	132.37	17.87	**79.97**
Unacademy	319.35	174.10	461.67	113.35	45.20	**222.73**
Simplilearn	-15.33	99.21	34.78	36.36	47.08	**40.42**

Table 3: Calculation of Avg. Growth percentage of the companies

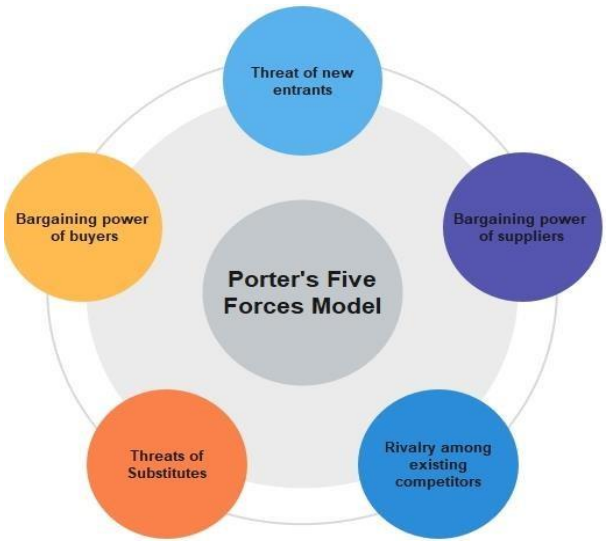
From the above data, we get to know that the companies had their ups and downs but on an average the growth rate has been significantly increasing showing a strong potential in this sector. Even though companies had a great upward run, some companies like BYJUs faced losses due to poor fund management and excessive hiring even though they were deemed the market leaders.

Overall the Ed-Tech vertical of the education sector showed a significant rise in past five financial years making it a strong market. Most companies' revenues spiked during COVID-19 pandemic and still showing stable growth. With ongoing demand for flexible learning and executive education, if companies adapt to changing market demand and set up a strong monetization strategies, will have the potential to thrive in the Indian markets.

1.2 Porter's Five Forces Analysis

Porter's Five Forces model, introduced in 1979 by Michael Porter, is a framework used to analyse the competitive environment of a business and help in identifying the key factors that influence profitability. These forces are necessary for a firm to understand to get the idea of the market and develop strategies based on it to minimize risks and maximize profits.

The Five Forces:



1. **Threat of New Entrants:** This speaks about accessibility or barriers to this industry which determines how easily a new competitor can enter the market.
2. **Threat of Substitutes:** This speaks about all the alternatives available for the customers in the market for a company's product.
3. **Bargaining power of Buyers:** This force describes the power customers have over the firm. If the product sold is something that is already been sold in the market by many other companies, customers can demand for better quality, cheaper price or different service than others.
4. **Bargaining power of Suppliers:** This describes the power held on by the frim when there are fewer substitutes. More power the firm possess, more they can dictate in a business.
5. **Competitive Rivalry:** This is the measure of the intensity of competitions in the existing firm. When there is too much of competition, firms might have to fight for customers by price cuts, improving quality or come up with something unique, which will squeeze out the firm's profits.

About Institute of Product Leadership:

Founded in 2012, the Institute of Product Leadership is a business school focused exclusively on product leadership, aiming to transform technology executives into future product managers and industry leaders.

The company primarily offers executive education and online certification courses, particularly in the field of product management. As a result, it falls under the Ed-Tech domain due to its hybrid and flexible classes. Integration of technology like online workshops, alumni forums, 1:1 live sessions and industry collaborations into higher education programs, further promotes digital learning.

1.3 Porter's Five Forces Analysis for Ed-Tech industry in India

1. Threat of New Entrants:

- Education industry has always been an open market in India and hence the barriers to enter this industry is quite low.
- There is always a threat for new entry and consumers switch between companies in search of quality and value. This reduces the brand loyalty.
- There are several government policies that support new startups, encouraging them to enter into the market with their own products.
- Building a brand image in this industry requires a large amount of investments and gain consumers' trust over time.
- By considering these statements we can say that the threat for new entrants are moderate because even with the government schemes and support, it requires significantly much higher investment to provide the quality of education consumers are looking for.

2. Threat of Substitutes:

- People still value offline college degrees over online certifications. Traditional degrees are still preferred by many over executive education or online certifications.
- Some may even experience fatigue due to long screen times and prefer books over soft copies. Adding on, some even opt for home schooling or classroom tutoring which reduces the demand for Ed-Tech.
- Different universities collaborate with certain Ed-Tech companies and provide identical courses in the market. This effects the profitability if the firm's product does not stand out in the market.
- Some might opt for free platforms like YouTube, which offers similar free educational content.
- Having all these hurdles, Threat of substitute is on the higher side as there are numerous alternatives for a given product.

3. Bargaining power of the Buyers:

- Education sector specifically does not target any particular demographic of customers, therefore it leaves a window for a wide range of products.
- Multiple Ed-Tech companies offer similar courses leaving the buyers with multiple options to choose which creates a demand for quality and uniqueness of the program offered.
- Cheap courses empower students to switch courses if their expectations are not met and customer retention becomes a problem.
- These aspects clearly show the power a buyer possesses in this industry make it hard for the firm to meet the expectations and demands.

4. Bargaining power of Suppliers:

- With the existence of multiple suppliers in the market, it reduces their individual bargaining power.
- One of the ways to increase supplier power is to prove the uniqueness of the product and promise the value provided for the price paid.
- Also the ones who have invested a lot to build their brand image and reputation in the market will be able to quote a higher price for the product.

3. Competitive Rivalry:

- Education market is flooded with Ed-tech companies operating nationwide. Companies have to use various marketing strategies if they want to stand out.
- They have to keep coming up with new innovations and different way of teaching while maintaining the quality of education to strive longer in the market.
- Building a good alumni network and industry partnership can make a company unique from others in the market.

The Indian Ed-Tech industry is a highly competitive market but also one of the fastest growing sectors. Competitiveness can be influenced by various factors that creates a constant new challenge to the companies. Due to low entry barriers, threat of entry remains high but sustaining in the market requires a large amount of investments. Like the earlier growth report indicated higher revenue generation but some companies faced losses due to high reinvestment amounts. With lack of understanding and people still choosing traditional education over online learning methods keeps the threat for substitutes on a higher side. Intense competitive rivalry resulted in lower product prices therefore increasing the buyer power and comparatively reducing the supplier power.

To strive in this industry, firms must catch up with the current trends and focus on product differentiation, better innovation and maintaining high quality of education.

1.4 Recent Trends in the Industry

With increasing demand and implementation of hybrid learning, currently the industry is equipping itself to satisfy the demand and tackle the competition.

- **Horizontal growth**: Horizontal growth in a company refers to expansion in its course offering by introducing new products that target different segment of customers like, K-12, executive higher educations and certifications, soft skills and language learning course, etc.
- **Technical Upskilling**: With evolution of technology and automation, it becomes a necessity to regularly up skill or learn new skills. Companies have caught up on this trends and are providing short duration certification programs to fulfil the industry demands.
- **Investing into new innovation**: Integration of new innovations like AI and chatbots are going to play a revolutionary role in education industry. Therefore, companies are already investing and developing different technologies that can be used to digitalize education.
- **Experiential learning**: Some companies have implemented experiential learning replacing traditional textbook education. Through this, these companies are able to provide hands-on experience than just theoretical concepts to enhance the quality of curriculum

1.5 Future Trends and Potential

As the Ed-tech sector continues to grow, here are the few future trends and the potential they hold to create product differentiation and better integration of technology in education;

- **Introducing GenAI and chatbots:** Artificial intelligence is playing a key role in our everyday life. It is always better to upgrade ourselves with the trends. GenAI, also known as generative AI, is a type of AI that generates pictures and videos based on texts. Using such tools helping the learners visualize the concepts will add a great value to the quality of learning. Chatbots stimulate human like conversation and with the use of this AI, firms can also provide features like 24/7 doubt solving sessions to ensure smooth flow of learning.
- **Industry Partnerships:** Collaborating with industry and tech leaders for hands on learning experience for students will be a great way to bridge the gap between academics and industry knowledge. Ed-tech companies can also be used as a training platforms for many multinational companies to align their company standards with the courses offered.

Since these are yet to be explored and the industry remains dynamic, companies can come up with innovative business models to survive high competitions and improvise customer retention.

Chapter 2 – Company Analysis

2.1 Introduction:

The Institute of Product Leadership is a premier business school, headquartered in Koramangala, Bengaluru. The institute is known for its executive MBA education in product management. It was established with the Executive Product Industry Council (EPIC), which is a group of elite product leaders who currently guide Indian product innovation in global markets.

Founded in 2012, the Institute of Product Leadership is India's first B-school for technology managers exclusively focusing on product leadership with the aim to bridge their transition into being future product managers.

The company also collaborates with various industry experts and MNCs to make their curriculum align with the current market demand. With this, Institute offers several executive programs, both online and classroom-based, including;

- E-MBA in Product Leadership
- Post-Graduate Program in Product Management
- Certified Associate Product Manager
- International Certificate in Strategy and Leadership.

The company also has a forum consisting of 4000+ alumni working in different multinational companies, establishing its presence in the product management education in Indian Ed-Tech industry.

2.2 Financial Analysis

Since its launch, The Institute of Product Leadership has been a private funded organization. Therefore, this report will be based on key financial aspects, as the exact numbers and revenue is not disclosed.

However, with these financial aspects like cost structure, mode of revenue, profitability and business strategies used, performance of the company can be analysed.

3. Costs and expenses:

- One of the major costs the company has to incur is paying the salary compensation for the teaching faculties and other industry leaders with whom they collaborated for experiential learning.
- Designing and updating the course syllabus as the market trends change requires a team of well-trained industry professionals which is another major cost for the institute.
- Implementation of technology and subscription payment of the LMS, AI tools and virtual classroom software.
- Administrative costs, employee salary, team maintenance and customer support is also incurred by the company.
- The company also invests in digital marketing, lead generation through various modes like Google Ads, Facebook Ads and content creation as this is the main source to generate leads.

b. Profitability:

- The certification vertical of the institute, bringing in around 35-50 sales every month costing 1 CONFIDENTIAL CONFIDENTIAL is the most profitable as it has a high profit margin and also the payments are done in US dollars. Currency appreciation and low operational costs for these online certification courses also adds to the gross profit of I CONFIDENTIAL r as of 31 March 2023.
- They also collaborated with numerous financial institutions for easy processing of education loans at rates of 8-10%, Low-cost EMI options and scholarship programs to attract a larger set of customers for expensive programs like E-MBA, which costs around 10 lakhs. Due to this, the company did not face any issues with the payment part and hence, increasing the cash flow.
- B2B collaborations for placements and internships are always a low risk source of income.

c. Mode of revenue:

- Even though the company's flagship program is E-MBA in product management, international certifications have been their high revenue generating courses.
- The company also conducts workshops and corporate training programs, main target being mid to senior level working professionals.
- The programs are accredited with CMR University for E-MBA program which again increases the value delivered.

d. Business strategies:

- Company's decision to introduce hybrid classes and online certifications post pandemic became a catalyst for its steady growth in the market.
- Adaptation of GenAI in their post-graduation programs have gained the consumers' attention.
- Product leaders' forum was introduced by the company, making it a platform for alumni to share their ideas and thoughts with other industry leaders. This was one of the successful initiative of the company to boost customer retention.

These aspects indicate different costs and income source for the company. The company enjoys a large profit range as the costs incurred are comparatively low but the net profit can vary due to several factors like market conditions, employee salary range or other operational plans. The company also maintains a healthy cashflow as the payments of the courses are done through bank loans or EMI option opted by the learner. Due to this, the company mostly relies on internal cash flow for its operations than any debts. Low debt ratio of the company also ensures long term stability and reduces financial burdens. Strong alumni network also generates new opportunities and word of mouth to spread, getting the company more enrolments.

From the industry analysis report we get to know that Ed-tech industry in India is growing on a good rate, generating new opportunities for the Institute of Product Leadership to differentiate their product in the market. As they continuously update their curriculum based on the new emerging trends, the company easily places its course apart and unique from those offered in Coursera and other online platforms.

2.3 Market Analysis

In the Ed-tech industry of India, Institute of Product Leadership places itself in a differentiated segment compared to other Ed-Tech companies that provide Product Management degree. With the Institute offering hands-on experience in product launch and experiential learning, it stands out from its main competitors, Coursera and UpGrad. However, the company still competes with well-established firms like ISB and IIMs and also the online companies like Simplilearn. While these companies provide generalized programs, Institute of Product Leadership still manages to create its focus into personalised curriculum, setting it apart from traditional learning.

With an estimate current valuation of $7.5 billion in 2024, the projected growth for this sector is at a CAGR of 25.8%, which will reach $29 billion by the end of 2030, the company still has a great potential to modernize education and catch up with the trending skills that is demanded in the market.

[Valuation refers to the estimated net worth of the company based on investors' interest, profitability and revenue]

2.4 Marketing analysis

Even though they can depend on organic leads due to overall market conditions, Institute of Product Leadership has a well-structured marketing strategy. It consists of digital outreach, content marketing, and word-of-mouth and social media marketing to enrich their product's digital presence.

1. **Digital outreach**:

   Digital outreach is a process of reaching the target audience by connecting with them online, engaging with potential customers and creating brand awareness in various ways.

   To attract working professionals looking for career transition, the company uses many different digital marketing tactics, some being;

   - **Social media engagement**: Company posts multiple ads in different social media platforms through paid channels and sponsorship. These ads are generally made through interviews of learners, explaining about their learning experience, etc.
   - **Online communities:** Some potential customers might reach through emails, comments in posts or raise a question in Quora. Active participation of the company in all these platforms, answering and clarifying discussions about product management and executive education, it makes itself visible in the market.
   - **SEO:** Search Engine Optimization is a process of optimizing its content to rank higher in search results. This is a source of attracting organic unpaid leads. Higher the rank, more the visibility of the website, increasing its traffic.
   - **Webinars:** The Company conducts free webinars for interested leads for spreading awareness of the program, encouraging their engagement eventually expecting conversions.

2. **Content Marketing:**

   It is a type of marketing focused on creating consistent, valuable and relevant content to attract and engage target audience. By providing this information, it helps the company develop trust with its authority and promoting the customers to take informed decision. Some of the effective methods used by the company are;

   - **Video content:** Creative videos and trending content are tweaked to promote the company's product helping it to reach a large audience. Reels and YouTube videos being a free source of content creation, the company utilizes it well and also improves its reach using YouTube SEO.

- **Newsletters:** Monthly or weekly newsletters are published through emails for the subscribers which provides valuable industry insights, current market trends and success stories of different individuals. This not only improves customer retention, consistency of this work also influences new prospects to join the program.

3. **Word-of-mouth:**

Being one of the most effective and powerful strategies, where satisfied students, alumni, teaching faculties and industry professionals share their experience with others through podcasts, blogs and other sources to promote the company's product.

- Company also has referral programs, where the learners or alumni get monetary incentives for referring the programs to others, for example, their colleagues and peers.
- Through industry partnerships, learners and faculties get to interact and network with multiple product leaders who then would spread the awareness of the company.

By implementing and promoting WOM strategy, the Institute of Product Leadership ensures the positive experiences and comments by the learners reach multiple potential customers, which becomes the catalyst for building a strong trust and bond with the company's product and learners.

2.5 SWOC Analysis

SWOC stands for strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and challenges. It is a vital tool used by analysts to analyse a company's internal and external factors that influence its growth. Once the company identifies these four areas, it can know its strengths, work on its weakness, catch on to the opportunities and find solutions for the challenges faced. For a business school like Institute of Product Leadership, this analysis will provide valuable insights on what to work on and understand their area of expertise.

1. **Strengths:**

Since the company has already differentiated its product in the market, it provides a huge upper hand in the market.

- **Concentrated on Product Leadership:** The Company falls under one of the few Ed-Tech that provides product management degree or certification. They are well-trained and experts in the product management domain.
- **Industry collaboration:** The course offered is structured by industry professionals and also provide hands-on experience to enhance their learning. By joining hands with many industries, it made the company to catch on to the industry trends much earlier than other competitors.
- **Strong financial management:** Funds within the company are managed very efficiently and utilized in the most valuable assets. There was never a delay in paying the salary for any employees or faculties and also the reimbursement processes are hassle-free. This is the key aspect for employee retention and smooth operation of the company.
- **Alumni Network:** Institute of Product Leadership operates a forum named Product leaders Forum, which is for all the alumni and the learners. This is a brilliant way to share business ideas and spread a word-of-mouth about the company.
- **Experiential Learning:** All the programs offered by the Institute are on the basis of experiential learning, i.e., all the learning happen in the form of activities, projects, industry training, etc. instead of traditional textbook learning.

2. **Weaknesses:**

A company can reach to the top only by its customers. One of the reasons the institute is lagging behind is brand awareness and lack of understanding.

- **Brand and product Awareness:** After differentiating itself from other equivalents, the company now straight up competes with ISB, IIMs and global business schools providing executive education. Adding on to it, in India, executive education is a new domain and not many people know about it or are confident about it.
- **Fees:** The fee structure is similar to that of courses offered in IIMs but compared to tier 1 universities, Institute of Product Leadership's brand recognition is relatively low. Due to this, company is losing on many potential interested customers.
- **Workspace:** The company follows an egalitarian work culture and has flexible timings. Even though it comes with its benefits, some employees do not take the tasks given seriously and also do not obey the individuals in senior positions. This will impact the working environment and also slows down the administrative productivity within the company.

3. **Opportunities:**

Functioning in an industry that is growing with CAGR rates at 25.8%, there are various opportunities to explore and implement,

- **Introduction of new courses:** Diversification is always a key for sustainability. As we are moving into data driven world, the institute can introduce data analytics and business analytics courses with its own differentiation as they did with Product management.
- **Expansion of executive education:** As they create brand awareness for executive education by conducting free webinars on its benefits, the institute can also launch E-MBA in many other specialisations outside product management.
- **B2B partnerships:** Introducing industry training programs exclusively tailored for particular companies. This can only be done through partnerships and collaborations with other MNCs.
- **Better SEO team:** To rank the website on top and increase visibility online, investing on SEO experts will be the only way to achieve this. Focusing on new trending keywords, optimizing content accordingly can help in brand visibility and eventually creating awareness.

4. **Challenges:**

Ed-Tech industry in India have multiple competitors, irrespective of the segment you focus on.

- **Competition:** Post pandemic, this industry is filled with companies providing numerous course and aggressive expansion of online platforms like 19ourser, reduces and dilutes the crowd and therefore effecting the revenue.
- **Rapid changes in the market:** After the introduction of AI, technology sector is seeing a rapid evolution. From GenAI to blockchains, there are multiple innovations being introduced to the market and it becomes hard to keep revising the curriculum.
- **Expansion of personalized learning:** One on One sessions and courses tailored based on the learner's demand is a key strategy used by Institute of Product Leadership to improvise the quality of education but following the same in a large scale will require a large team and is not cost efficient during future expansions.

The Institute of Product leadership is a well-established company with all the specialized and personalized courses, but to be constantly visible in the market with competitors like ISMs and IIMs, the company must focus on brand awareness and better marketing strategies. Adding on, it must also address the problems caused in the workspace with better policies and effective management strategies to improvise the team performances.

2.6 Ongoing trends in the company

Focusing on the recent trends and changes took place in the company, here are the few that had a major impact on the business;

1. **Introduction of AI-related subjects:** In the recent changes in their curriculum, the module designing team introduced a new concept of GenAI, where the learners get to understand about the new AI tools and its implementation in product management domain.
2. **Growth and Performance marketing:** The Company recently began investing into digital marketing to increase brand outreach. Instead of hiring digital marketers, the decision was made to delegate the tasks into different individuals, each specifically handling a part of digital marketing. Currently the digital marketing team consists of social media marketer, performance marketer, growth marketer, SEO specialist, GTM Engineer- Lead generation specialist and event marketer.
3. **Alumni Engagement:** By building a strong alumni network, it becomes easier for the company to have more B2B collaborations in the future.

2.7 Company Forecasts:

With cheap internet and increasing demand for upskilling and learning new technology, the industry is expected to focus on these key factors;

1. **Decentralized certifications:** One of the perfect use of blockchains is to avoid fake certificates and improve the value of certifications. Blockchains are decentralized records [a method of record-keeping that stores and shares data through multiple computer networks in fragmented form instead of single authority controlling the data], used to ensure security and avoid tampering of data. Information is stored in multiple pieces called blocks forming chains in network which cannot be altered or accessed without the consent of all the agreed owners of the data. This eliminates the possibility of fake certificates and easily verified by the source.
2. **International Collaborations:** Many students prefer to study abroad but are unable to go because of the living expenses and other costs. Ed-tech industries can partner with global institutes to offer courses tailored by those institutes for better learning experience and also provide exposure to their education system.

By implementing new innovations in a right way, we can reduce the possible risks associated with Ed-tech industries, mainly being tampered certificates, risk of data breach and affordability of certain courses.

Study outcomes:

In these two chapters, we evaluated and completed industry and company analysis based on the Institute of Product Leadership belonging to Ed-tech industry.

Indian Ed-Tech industry growing at a CAGR of 25.8%, has been one of the fastest growing sector post pandemic. This significant growth, driven by increasing demand for upskilling courses, executive education and hybrid learning, creates a space for emerging companies to enter into education industries. Majorly ruled by IIMs, ISB and Coursera, this industry is expected to reach a projected evaluation of $29 billion by 2030. With the rapid growth there are multiple challenges the companies have to face such as heavy competition, constant innovation and improvising learner engagement.

The Institute of Product Leadership is a specialized business school for executive education in product management. The courses offered are UGC approved and has a unique curriculum focusing on experiential learning and hands-on industry experience. Through company analysis we also get to know about their different courses and workshops helping them to build multiple revenue streams and their marketing strategies leading to company's rapid growth.

Chapter 3 – Discussion on conceptual knowledge applied during internship

3.1 Introduction

As a part of my BBA curriculum, I got an opportunity to do a 16 week internship where I could implement my conceptual knowledge gained in my initial semesters in a corporate world. As an intern in HR Department of Institute of Product Leadership (IPL), I was able to apply the learnings such as Business Communication, recruiting, working on Job Description, HRP, on-boarding, operational tasks and many more.

With the knowledge I've gained during the internship and from my university, in this chapter, I'd like to highlight on the challenges I've came across and the concepts I've used to solve the same. The discussion also shines light on the core human resource concepts such as, screening, recruiting, employee engagement, performance evaluation, feedback system, etc. and how they helped me through this journey to ensure a smooth recruiting experience for both candidates and the organization.

3.2 Implementation of HRM concepts:

During the internship period, several challenges came in front that had to be addressed using the theoretical concepts of HRM. This section mainly focuses on the use of different strategies and OB factors used to solve the issues faced during talent acquisition. Every challenge put on my table was taken as an opportunity to implement my classroom learning tweaking it according to the organization's requirements.

1. **Business Communication:**
   On the initial days of the internship, one of the key observation was made was the inconsistency in the communication between the applicants and the HR Team. Emails and feedbacks had unstructured and general format and also faced delays due to manual tracking systems.

   Candidates were not able to respond on time or lost interest, leading them to drop the applications and move on to other companies. This created a bad impression hence, led to drop in applicant count.

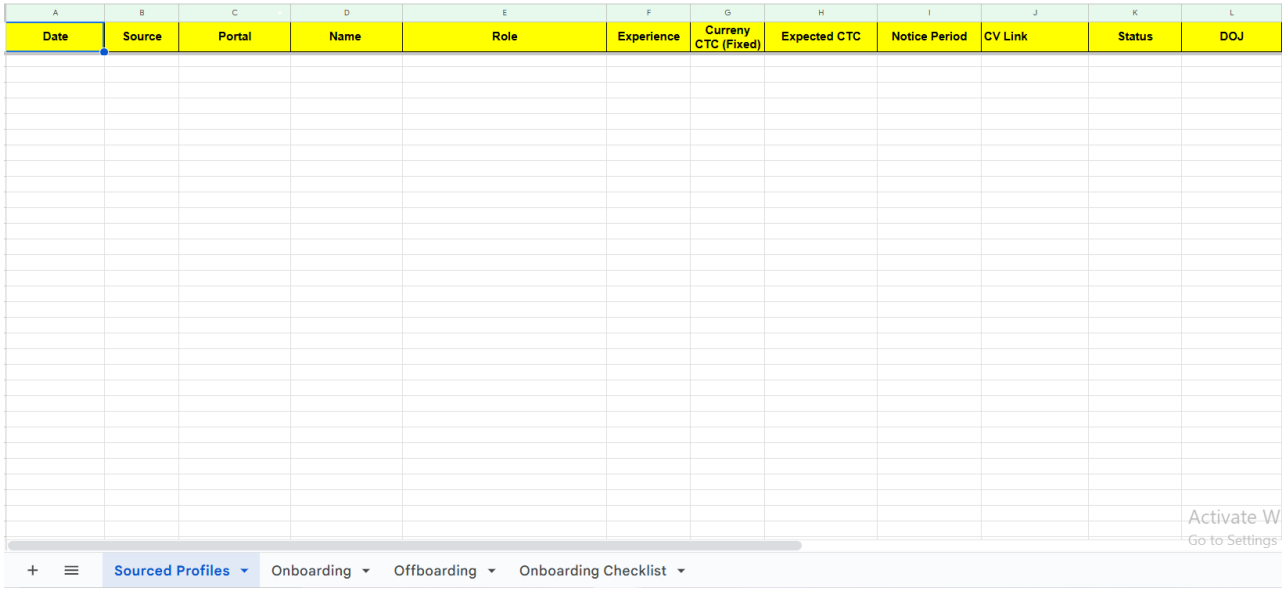
   To overcome this issue, we restructured the messages for;

   - **Interview invitation emails**: We added more insights about the company, provided them resources on which they had to prepare for the interview, attached the job description and resume to the same invites allowing easy access to both candidates and hiring managers and linked it to Google calendar for easy tracking of the interviews.
   - **Personalized reminders:** Since we do not schedule more than 5 interviews a day, we replaced a reminder email or texts with phone call. We called the candidates before the interview as a reminder and this also helped us understand their needs and wants better based on which we could guide them to ensure a smooth process.
   - **Professional Tone:** With the use of AI tools and educational videos, we taught ourselves to communicate with candidates in a professional manner and use right corporate terminologies in our emails replacing the old casual approach to the candidates.

   With these small yet effective changes, we could see a significant increase in candidate engagement and also we could set up more interviews efficiently.

2. **Inefficient Tracking system:**
As the number of applicants increased due to increase in requirements, another challenge we came across was to track applicant status. Since it is a start-up and a bootstrap company, they did not invest in any ATS systems and relied on Google calendar invites. Due to this, it was difficult to remember the details of the candidates to provide personalized constructive feedbacks and to know their application status.

We later decided to design an excel sheet to track the candidate status. The excel sheet was created using Google sheets to enable collaborations and multiple access with the HR and hiring managers. With this, we had a single platform for easy tracking.



Date	Source	Portal	Name	Role	Experience	Curreny CTC (Fixed)	Expected CTC	Notice Period	CV Link	Status	DOJ

Sourced Profiles | Onboarding | Offboarding | Onboarding Checklist

Fig.: Format of the Google sheets.

The above picture shows the format of the tracking system we made using Google sheets. Following are the terminologies used and their purpose;

- Date captures when the candidate was first sourced. With this we could track how long did the hiring process take.
- Under source, we enter if the candidate profile was through internal reference or from the HR Team. Whoever from the team sourced the profile entered their name in the sheet. This helped us to track the performance of the recruiters and calculate individual conversion rates.
- Portal refers to the channel that was used to source the profiles. E.g., Linkedin, Naukri, Indeed, etc.
- Name of the candidate played an important role for easy searches and avoid any duplication of profiles.
- Role specifies the position of the candidate they applied for. Through this we could build pipeline and use filters to find individual job openings and its applicants.
- Experience had a vital role in shortlisting and filtering out profiles to make a priority list for the interviews.
- Current CTC of the candidates helped in decision making and budgeting for the company. Compensation plays a major part in offer negotiation as we go with market standard hike of 25 to 30% for which current fixed component of the CTC is needed.

- Expected CTC of the candidates help us to build a budget for new roles and understand the market package for the particular role.
- Notice Period tells us how long the candidate will take to join the organization after accepting the offer. This helps us to schedule on-boarding and arrange the assets.
- Linking the CV ensures a quick access to the candidates' resumes whenever the hiring managers want to refer to them.
- Status tracks the candidates' current position in the recruiting process. Terms that come under status are, screened, R1 interview, R2 Interview, Offer sent, rejected, etc.
- DOJ refers to the date of joining of the candidate.

There are sheets such as sourced profiles, on-boarding, off-boarding and on-boarding checklist. While sourced profiles contains the above mentioned details, on-boarding and off-boarding contains the name of the candidates that are on-boarded and off-boarded respectively. On-boarding checklist is a list of processes that has to be done during the on-boarding.

By building this structured, yet simple application tracker, we were able to efficiently handle the large number of candidates which reduced the hiring cycle and helped us with timely updates and personalized feedbacks. Further updates that can be done to this systems are, automated reminders, conditional formatting for candidates who were selected and rejected and build pivot tables to measure recruiter's performance.

3. Low Conversion rate:

Another major challenge that was put in front of us during my internship was low candidate conversion rate. Number of interviews scheduled was much higher than the number of candidates who got the offer and the number of candidates who accepted the offer and joined the company was also not stable. This increased the hiring time, wasted resources like time and money and also increased the pressure on other employees due to a vacancy.

As a team we came together to analyse the issue and bring in changes in the strategies and budget allocation. After analysing we realized the main problem that caused this issue were;

- Delay in closing the position.
- Candidates were unaware of the work culture and company policies like, 6 days working.
- Candidates did not have role clarity and their expectations on the compensation was not met.
- Failed follow-ups before the application tracker was made.

To resolve this problem, we used several HR theoretical concepts and tweaked it according to the company's requirements;

- **Well-structured screening calls:** We improvised our screening pitch and added more open ended questions. With this, we were able to understand the candidate's requirements and wrote down the type of skill set they possess so we can tailor the job role to benefit both candidate and the company. The job description and the company policies were also explained and discussed with the candidates during the screening calls to avoid any last minute confusions. This decreased our major concerns of our candidates not having job clarity and misunderstanding company policies.
- **Optimized invitation timings:** While scheduling the interviews of high priority roles, we blocked the calendars for the hiring managers for multiple roles on the same day. This helped us

reduce the waiting time and also saved up time for the candidates as they could give multiple rounds on the same day. We conducted offer discussion over a phone call instead of scheduling another face to face round which further saved time. As a result the hiring time for one candidate came down to 7 to 10 days from 12 to 15 days as practiced before.

- **Culture fit rounds:** Alongside the final round, the hiring managers were requested to conduct a 5 minute culture fit round in which doubts of candidates were cleared and discuss about the roles and responsibilities, workplace environment, possible challenges they might have to face and many more. This gave them a clear picture of the company before they joined and we also noticed not only a significant rise in conversion rate but also the candidates were able to adopt quicker comparatively, which again saved up time and resources during their training period.
- **Feedbacks after every round:** Recruiters not only were just a point of contact, we also ensured to take feedbacks from the hiring managers after every round and give a constructive feedback, areas of improvements and a brief about the next rounds to the candidates, helping them prepare and perform better on the upcoming rounds. This small act of mentorship made us receive multiple positive feedbacks and also help the candidates connect better with the HR team during any troubles pre or post interviews.
- **Competitive offers:** Budget allocation was also revised to meet the current market salary demand and this helped us match the requirements of the candidates. Retention bonus was given for candidates who completed one year in the organization.

By working on communication strategies, personalized approach towards candidates, improvising interview processes and building a better tracking system helped to address the issues of expectations mismatch and increase the conversion rate. Not only that, we were also able to reduce the hiring time and were able to focus more on building stronger pipelines.

4. Skill assessment tests:

While interviews were conducted, especially for marketing and tech roles, resume and interview based hiring would not give the best results. Hence, the team came up with scenario based or situation based assignments that were given to the candidates to assess their skills in the domain and also help us evaluate according to our requirements.

This brought in fairness and equality in evaluation. Candidates were hired for their skills and competencies rather than judging them based on their experience and communication. These assessments had different scoring criteria based on creativity, relevancy, clarity and problem solving ability.

By implementing this, we could identify better suited candidates for the job roles. Hiring managers were also satisfied during the final rounds as the candidates selected were skilled and competent. It also helped us save time as we could give assignments to multiple candidates at the same time and keep easy track of it using the Google sheets. Even though the process is efficient, there is always a room for improvements;

- Company can use automated testing tools for initial screening assessments to reduce the burden.
- Feedback forms can be given to candidates to understand their perspective on the assignment and improvise accordingly.
- Interactive scenarios like role plays, case studies can also be implemented.
- Update the assessment process regularly to keep up with the current market trends.

Introduction of skill assessment tests helps us screen profiles that align with our job requirements. It not only reduces the hiring errors but also helps the candidates get a better understanding on the job role they will be working on.

5. **Constructive Feedback:**

Feedbacks are one of the important parts of the recruitment process, which not only helps the candidate to learn and grow but also helps the company on which trait they have to focus on during the training session. Earlier, candidates did not get any updates after the interviews and even if they did, it was the automated mail that was shared by the system letting them know if they were selected for the next round or not. Candidates who did not receive updates generally held on to hopes of being selected but never heard back from the company. This often left a bad impression on the job market.

Main reason this happened was because of a small HR Team and completely relying on automated emails. To resolve this issue;

- We removed the automated rejection mails and created an email template that was customized based on the interview feedbacks. Instead of a general rejection mail, the candidates were informed the reason for rejection, which part they had to improve on and what they could've done instead. This made them feel more connected and also helped them grow career-wise. Transparency in the process also brought in good reviews in platforms like Glassdoor, indirectly boosting company's impression in job market.
- Apart from emails, calls were also scheduled after each round to give them the hiring manager's feedback and also get the candidate's feedback on the interview. This helped both company and the candidates as we both got a clear understanding on each other's expectations. Candidates could prepare accordingly which helped them get the job.

Implementation of these small changes showed how small changes in communication and providing a helping hand to the candidates helped the company significantly improve its hiring efficiency. HRM theories on organizational behaviour and also the study on approaching people from different generations accordingly played an important role in improvising organizational culture and retention rate of the employees. Understanding the concepts like building motivation, using multiple leadership styles based on the situation and people and bringing in the culture of transparency, helped in enhancing the employee engagement which therefore aligned the human needs with organizational goals.

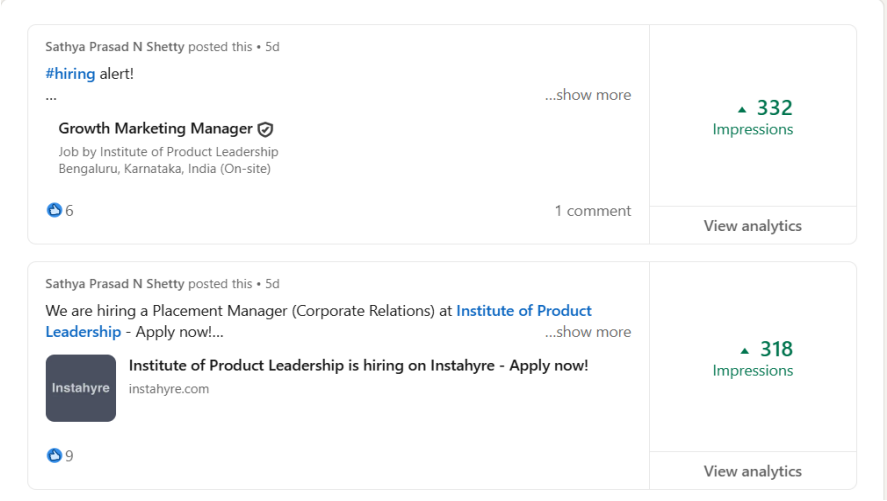
6. **Improvising outreach and SEO methods:**

Apart from regular job posts, we also used LinkedIn to increase the number of applicants. One major thing that I observed was that regular posts reached way less than keyword specific posts. While researching about this I was introduced to a concept called search engine optimization (SEO). SEO is a process of improving reach, visibility and engagement of a content (job postings in this case) by using appropriate keywords that are trending, hashtags related to the content and structuring the content in a way for it to reach the targeted audience. All these were generated organically and without any paid campaigns.

By pushing the reach of the job post in multiple platforms, it helped us to get more profiles for screening and hence, saved time.

To achieve this, we used multiple techniques to maximize the outreach and optimize the content for SEO and search discovery;

- **Optimizing content:** After researching and use of AI tools, we made a list of words that are trending in that targeted domain. Numerous keywords were added that were generally searched by people. For e.g., in the recent job posts of growth marketing manager and placement managers, we used keyword like "Growth marketing", "Digital marketing", "Placement managers", "Corporate relations", etc. These are simple yet effective keywords as people tend to search words on the search bars and this helps our post to come in the front, improving our visibility.
- **Use of Hashtags:** Using hashtags helps us to position our job post in different groups, each hashtag acting as an individual groups, we can use multiple hashtags to boost the organic reach.



Thus, out of 650 overall impressions created on the job posts, 68 to 112 users have clicked on the job links which shows us that the job post has reached the right set of audience.

With the use of SEO and closely monitoring on analytical data, we were able to prove that even without advertising spend, a significant growth in organic traffic was achievable. Given below is a screenshot of a graph from LinkedIn analytics that show the hike in organic traffic every time a post was made, i.e., 3rd April, 15th April and 20th April 2025.

	Value	**Growth compared to previous posts**
Impressions	2,257	+56.4%
Avg. impressions per post	325	+132%
Highest traffic for a single post	**730**	

Table 4: Traffic count change due to SEO technique

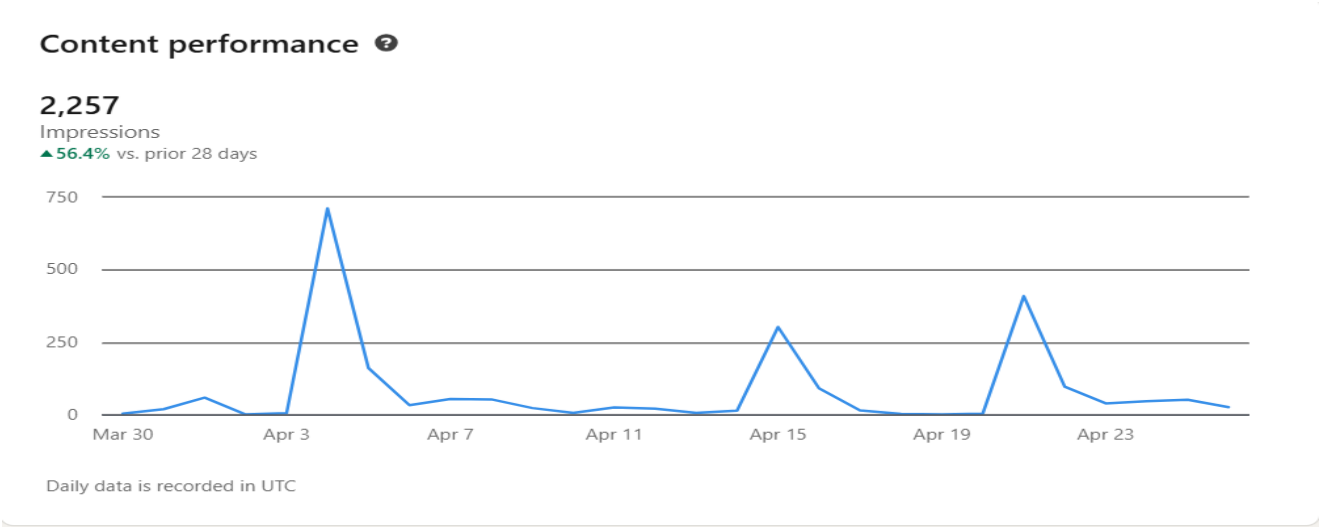


Fig.: Overall traffic generated on LinkedIn

3.3 Conclusion:

The internship was not only a platform to work but also a place where the theories studied and the conceptual knowledge gained during the initial three semesters of my BBA degree. Concepts taught in classes such that organizational behaviour, generational gap understanding, business communication concepts and analytical skills played a vital role during this period. Apart from this, knowledge gained through business strategies course done from Coursera, data analytics and SEO techniques I've gained during my internship journey helped me overcome the challenges that was brought in front of me. I also had some to share my knowledge with the team and help them set up the applicant tracker, make optimized posts and many more.

By handling inefficiencies, I've realized the need for changing the theoretical concepts and restructuring according to the practical realities. With the completion of this chapter, I came to an understanding that HR is not just about managing processes but also about engaging and connecting with people, helping them grow and also building strong foundation for the organization's sustainability.

Chapter 4 – Best Practices and experiential learning

4.1 Introduction:

During my internship period in the Institute of Product Leadership, I got exposure into different domains in HR. Even though I joined there as a Talent Acquisition Intern, I was given multiple other operational tasks to handle apart from recruiting. It helped me develop soft skills, management, processes of recruiting and HR operations. The following sections describe the overall learning experience in detail giving a better understanding about all the concepts and experience gained.

4.2 Organizational Behaviour and communication:

Studying organizational behaviour helped me understand people and their mindset; uniqueness in their behaviour and how to communicate with people coming from different generation. While millennials thrive for growth and purpose, Gen Z bring in entrepreneurial mindset into the company. Another main factor that was observed was Gen Z lacked patience compared to Baby Boomers or Millennials. They wanted quick feedbacks and faster processes while older generation did not mind waiting. We had to prioritize the feedback mails accordingly to avoid any inconvenience.

The way we communicated with our colleagues and our candidates also mattered a lot. While writing the feedbacks we had to carefully choose the words which will deliver a positive message to the candidates. We also realized the tone of the emails mattered a lot. Freshers needed more elaborated feedback as it helped in their career journey while the experienced candidates just needed the place where they went wrong.

More we understand the concept of OB and business communication, we realize it is not only an academic subject but also plays a vital role in building professional relationships and stronger connections with people.

4.3 Structured processes and database management:

Having a structured process and proper database will make a lot of operational tasks much more efficient and easy. We realized this when there were multiple hiring needs and we had to handle a larger pool of candidates for the same. After creating a database for candidate tracking through Google sheets and having a fixed process for sourcing, screening, interviews and recruiting, helped us realize the inefficiency in our previous process and significant improvements in current ones.

- Candidate tracker that was designed and managed helped us to capture the complete hiring processes a candidate when through before getting their offer letter. The database had all the necessary information from compensation to their resume. The experience of being part of building such a database made me realize the importance of record keeping and its importance in maintaining the workflow. Since all the data were present in one place it helped us to take data driven decision instead of depending just on feedbacks.
- Professionalism in emails was one of the important lessons gained during my internship. Whether it is your colleague, team members, managers or candidates, I understood the importance of following a structural format to ensure clear and polite communication. This was necessary because in corporate, emails are the primary evidence for any work done or communication made. It held the company's reputation whenever it was delivered to an external stakeholder. Brand image becomes extremely important during B2B communication as the email creates the first impression.
- Learning to use Google calendar for interview scheduling was a great use of technology. It was a one stop solution to write invitation mails, add in hiring managers for the interview, attach all the documents, set reminders for the interview and also use the zoom link or Google meet link for the

same. This avoided confusions and we did not have to send the details separately. The process was so efficient and easy to learn that requires just one hour of training.

- I also understood the importance of confidentiality when all the process was digitalized. Protecting portals and documents with passwords, use of one time passwords for certain important files that contained information of salary, personal documents, etc. Encryption of company documents has prevented the possibility of data breach.

With this, I truly appreciate the importance of structured processes and the importance of maintain a database for efficient hiring and positive candidate experience.

4.4 Analytical skills:

Apart from theories, we were encouraged to think out of the box and experiment with our ideas. In this growing world filled with technology and data, we got an opportunity to learn about basics of SEO and also use it for our digital outreach strategies. This helped us take data-driven decisions, analyse the outcomes, test different methods and make a note of the strategies for future use.

Use of tools like Excel and PowerBI to calculate drop off rates, conversion rates and ratio based analytics, allowed us to identify the bottlenecks early and also forecast the future outreach. While analysing the SEO data, another important factor that was noticed was the time when you post. Posting a job openings late evening around 6 PM and during weekends provided better results compared to the rest.

Conducting regular surveys and collecting data had become a regular task. The types of surveys that were conducted and their uses are mentioned below:

- **Interview feedback forms**: After completion of all the rounds of the interviews, feedback forms were shared to the candidates. This let them give their opinions and experiences they had during the recruiting process. This helped us understand the changes we had to make in our assessment tests, customize our screening questions, etc.
- **Employee Engagement form**: This was given to the employees on timely basis to understand their needs and requirements, take in their suggestions for changes and also get their opinion on work culture. This was an anonymous form which eliminated the chances of bias and encourage genuine opinions.
- **Off-Boarding form:** We also provided a survey sheet for the employees who are leaving the company. During the exit formalities, we requested them to fill this to understand their experience in the company, problems they have faced and their suggestions for improvements.

Getting an insights on the application of analytics while working as a recruiter, proves the importance of having the knowledge to work with data in the upcoming AI-focused world. Letting us experiment with our creative thinking and writing down our results helped us understand the mistakes we did and let us learn from it.

In the world of endless possibilities, mistakes are always a key that leads to improvements. Additionally with regular surveys, we were able to implement in continuous improvement and employee satisfaction. The value of TQM (total quality management) theory of HRM, becames clear, as it focuses on long term success by continuous improvements on processes to bring in customer satisfaction, in this case, both employees and candidates. This method is also called Kaizen. It is a Japanese term for ‘change for betterment’. This approach focuses us involving employees and their opinions in every step of organizational decision-making.

4.5 Management Skills:

Managing things in a right way is a key aspect while working in a corporate environment. The methods you use and finding out an efficient way to get things done all add up to our productivity. To improvise productivity, it is important to get the maximum results using minimum inputs. During this time of work, I have understood the significance of time and resource management, trying to give out the best results with limited resources available.

While working in a bootstrap start-up, I got to know the necessity for cost management in the organization. Company did not fund much on hiring portals and generally relied on free posts and internal references. This did not put down our productivity, instead, it motivated us to come up with creative ideas to get the things done.

Resource management was not just limited to paid portals, it also extended to people, building pipelines for backup and many more. The company pays for 15 paid postings for Naukri for a year and it is strictly saved for urgent hiring or mass hiring. Other times, we rely on LinkedIn, Indeed, iimjobs, UpDazz, etc. LinkedIn allowed one free post at a time with a limit of 50 applicants. Since we received good quality applicants from LinkedIn, we used this portal more. With the help of our colleagues, we posted multiple job openings in different individual accounts and kept a track on who posted what. In this way we used LinkedIn's free job post whenever we had to close multiple positions. At times, we created search engine optimized posts with trendy captions to reach the target audience and attached the job links of other free portals. This increased our visibility and application pool. We also requested the hiring managers to repost our job posts and share it with their connections, as every engagement was a free promotion to us.

To make the best use of time, we made our personalized time tables on Google Calendar, ensuring all the daily tasks are done. This avoided overlapping of tasks and cause any inefficiencies. Tasks were also grouped for multi-tasking in such a way that, a difficult time consuming work was paired with low priority operational or administrative work. For example, screening calls for a job role 'Customer Experience Specialist' took at least 15 to 20 minutes as we had to explain the job role and clear the doubts of the candidates in the initial screening call. This was quite exhausting we had to take breaks after each call. To utilize this time, this task was combined with updating the database. After every call, when we took a break, we updated the candidate database. With this, we made sure to get both the work done at the same time.

Management skills are fundamental part for thriving in any professional role. To maintain quality and deliver results under pressure helped me train myself to be ready for the corporate setting. Traits like problem-solving, proactive mindset, planning and digital knowledge make me feel confident to tackle any future roles.

4.6 Personalization in passive candidate engagement:

Passive candidates are the ones who have not applied for the job but are open for new opportunities. When we face shortage of applications, we search for people who are open for better opportunities through portals like FoundIt and LinkedIn. Approaching such candidates require precise and respectful corporate communication skills and a personalized strategy based on their profile because one wrong move can affect the company's brand image in the job market.

Mainly, we need to respect their time and professional experience they bring in and another factor is to identify the type of personality they possess. We will have to change the approach based on their experience, age and the way they start communicating. By learning all this psychological factors, I learnt to quickly switch my approach from persuasion to advertising the job or from advertising to a friendly communication based on the replies they give and their needs and wants.

Instead of having a robotic approach in calls like, “Are you looking for a job?” or a text message reaching out to them, I worked on building empathy and connection with every candidate I called. More they feel connected with you, less they get annoyed from your calls. As I learnt this in the early stages of my internship and worked on different approaches, it helped me to close multiple positions through this method.

Another method I used for approaching was by telling them how their past experience aligns well with the company’s requirements and the opportunity they get to grow in this new role, instead of just sending them the job descriptions expecting them to read.

By implementing these strategies, I was able to bring down the time taken to source a profile significantly and also saw an improvement in candidate quality. From my personal perspective, this new technique I learnt during my internship not only brought in good results but also helped me boost my confidence, improve my communication and use better terminologies while speaking.

4.7 Conclusion:

Developing and learning new skills are always beneficial in a competitive world. During this internship, I got an opportunity to apply the theoretical knowledge I knew and also learn new skills from my peers or my managers.

Observing generational differences, understanding organizational behaviour and the power corporate communication holds in building connections and rapport taught me the value of having strong professional relationship. The overall experience made me be more empathetic, productive and mainly competent. It is never too much, when it comes to learning and gaining knowledge. With the increasing demand for skills and productivity, it is necessary for us to keep ourselves up to date and implement the philosophy of continuous improvement in our lifestyle.

How you get the things done is more important than getting things done. Learning to create trackers, manage database and using analytical tools, opened multiple opportunities to improvise personal and team efficiency. Working with limited resource, I realized that creativity and strategic thinking plays a vital role coming up with multiple new outcomes. Use of analytics in recruiting to get better insights and take data driven decisions developed my interest towards the data analytics world.

Overall it was not just a journey of recruiting but also an amazing platform to let your creative minds make the best out of the available resource and using the modern technologies to benefit your outcomes. Even in the digital era, I learnt that value, empathy and personalization brings in during inter-personal communications. This internship journey has been a great experience, providing good exposure to the corporate world and also a place for personal growth.

Chapter 5 – Summary of Fortnightly progress

During my internship in the Institute of Product Leadership as a Talent Acquisition intern, I was mainly assigned to source and screen profiles. But with the support of my manager and the director of sales, I was given more HR and operations related tasks as my learning process. Over the time, I understood about recruitment cycles, different tools used, AI-based softwares and also developed inter-personal communication skills.

My journey as a recruiter in this company started on 4th December 2024. Initially I was asked to research about the company and its competitors alongside understand the functioning of various department. After the competitor analysis, my manager guided through the policies and procedures we follow in the company. I was also asked to study various job descriptions to ensure a clear understanding about the job roles I will be handling. This also helped me increase my accuracy in sourcing the profiles and ask relevant questions during the screening call. My first roles that I worked on were inside sales specialist and Sr. Word Press Developer.

Seeing my performance, I was also asked to schedule interviews directly as the profiles sourced were good and did not had to be reviewed. Then, I was introduced to Google Calendar and my manager mentored me on how to use it and schedule interviews. Additionally, I maintained and updated a database of candidates ensuring timely reminders and personalized feedback. Since, I was able to close the positions earlier than the deadline, my tasks expanded to new roles, Corporate Relations Associate and SEO Expert. During this, I got an opportunity to collaborate with the marketing and customer experience team to thoroughly understand the job roles and responsibilities. While preparing for it, I also learnt the basics of SEO and used this skill to make job posts in LinkedIn for better outreach.

For roles like, SEO Expert, Sr. Word Press Developer and motion graphic designer, we designed skill assessment tests and evaluated candidates based on that. Timely reminders and feedbacks were sent to the candidates regarding the assessment tests. New job portals like FoundIt, Naukri, Indeed were given to me so that I can get more qualified profiles. While working for marketing team, I learnt the difference between Product manager and Product Marketing manager. With this difference, I could now easily identify good profiles while sourcing the candidates for Product Marketing managers.

We also targeted Passive candidates if we came across any good profiles. A different approach had to be taken for such profiles as they have not applied for the job and are open for better opportunities. Main portals used for this was InstaHyre, FoundIt and LinkedIn.

From March, hiring for inside sales role expanded and now it was based on verticals. Our company had three verticals, namely, E-MBA, Technology MBA and Certifications. Each vertical had their own requirements and I had to work closely with the hiring managers for deeper understanding.

I was given an opportunity to conduct on-boarding of my candidates for my learning, explaining them company policies, assisted them ID creation and biometrics, asset allocation and introducing them to their team members.

Throughout the internship, every day was a learning to me. I developed new skills, learnt to use new tools and portals, understood the HR processes and improved my management skills.

REFERENCES

1. https://doi.org/10.1186/s41239-020-00223-0
2. https://www.wallstreetprep.com/knowledge/cagr-compound-annual-growth-rate/
3. Porter's Five Forces Analysis: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Porter%27s_five_forces_analysis#
4. https://www.coursehero.com/file/77585837/PORTERdocx/
5. Company overview: https://tracxn.com/d/companies/product-leadership/__Jq1S5vcFz96PbHy6cx0LB7TJWDwE_JKljl1E8RZ0tAY?#about-the-company
6. Innovation in Ed-Tech industry: https://www.investindia.gov.in/blogs/opportunities-indias-edtech-industry-driving-innovation-and-accessibility

satya internship

ORIGINALITY REPORT

4%	4%	%	2%
SIMILARITY INDEX	INTERNET SOURCES	PUBLICATIONS	STUDENT PAPERS

PRIMARY SOURCES

1	Submitted to Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE) Student Paper	1%
2	www.coursehero.com Internet Source	1%
3	Submitted to University of Northampton Student Paper	<1%
4	www.productleadership.com Internet Source	<1%
5	www.pagalguy.com Internet Source	<1%
6	www.slideshare.net Internet Source	<1%
7	165commonwealth.com Internet Source	<1%
8	insis.vse.cz Internet Source	<1%
9	writing.ra6.org Internet Source	<1%
10	Submitted to Cambridge Education Group Student Paper	<1%
11	fastercapital.com Internet Source	<1%
12	sadani.feedspot.com Internet Source	<1%

13	checkify.com Internet Source	<1 %
14	gitarattan.edu.in Internet Source	<1 %
15	dspace.cvut.cz Internet Source	<1 %
16	northfieldil.org Internet Source	<1 %

Exclude quotes	On	Exclude matches	< 3 words
Exclude bibliography	On		